RETAINED EXECUTIVE SEARCH · INDIA LEADERSHIP HIRING · GCC BUILDOUTS

Critical hiring, run with *search discipline.*

Talhive partners with global companies on **retained executive search, India leadership hiring, GCC buildouts and embedded hiring programs** where precision, speed and accountability matter more than volume.

HEADQUARTERED
India · Vietnam
Global since 2021

FOUNDED
2016
Nine year operating record

ENGAGEMENT
Retained only
Full commitment, both sides

BY THE NUMBERS · 2016 TO 2025

01 · GLOBAL CLIENTS
270+
Across India, USA, EU and Southeast Asia.

02 · CURATED TALENT
20K+
Pre vetted senior professionals in our network.

03 · PLACEMENTS
1,200+
Successful senior closes 2016 to 2025.

04 · CLIENT NPS
97
Net Promoter Score. B2B benchmark is +31.

HIRING · STREAMLINED

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The one page version

Senior hiring does not fail at sourcing. It fails *before the search is designed.*

Talhive replaces CV supply with an operating system for high consequence hiring: mandate architecture, passive market mapping, evidence led assessment, founder led closure.

01

THE RISK

Where senior *searches break.*

- Misaligned briefs at kickoff
- Wrong target company map
- Active outreach to passive market
- Slow decision loops on the client side
- Weak assessment beyond the CV

02

THE TALHIVE MODEL

One operating system, *four pillars.*

- **Mandate architecture** before market entry
- **Passive mapping** across target firms
- **Evidence led** 12 dimension assessment
- **Founder led** closure and onboarding
- Single accountable partner per mandate

03

THE RESULT

Repeatable senior *outcomes.*

- Faster shortlists, fewer restarts
- **1,200+** placements 2016 to 2025
- **270+** clients across four regions
- **20K+** curated senior network
- Founder led on every retained mandate

SOURCE Talhive operating data 2016 to 2025 · SHRM 2024 hiring benchmarks · LinkedIn Talent Solutions 2024 · ChurnZero B2B NPS benchmark.

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WHO THIS IS FOR

Ideal Client Profile

We work where hiring has *strategic consequence.*

01

PROFILE A

Global companies *building India capability.*

First country leadership, engineering and product teams, GCC setup, senior India operators. Typically US, EU or Southeast Asia headquartered.

GCC BUILDOUTS | COUNTRY LEADERSHIP | INDIA CAPABILITY

02

PROFILE B

Funded tech companies *scaling leadership.*

Series A to C, founder led teams. AI, SaaS, fintech, infrastructure, product led companies hiring their next decisive senior layer.

SERIES A – C | FOUNDER LED | AI · SAAS · FINTECH

03

PROFILE C

VC / PE backed firms *under execution pressure.*

Leadership reset, critical replacement, senior technical hiring, market entry. Portfolio companies needing CXO, VP or Head of hires with urgency.

LEADERSHIP RESET | CRITICAL REPLACEMENT | MARKET ENTRY

WHERE WE ARE NOT THE PARTNER

High volume junior hiring, CV forwarding mandates, non exclusive success fee searches, or roles where **the hiring team cannot commit time to calibration and decision making.**

COVERAGE India (Mumbai · Pune · Bengaluru) · Vietnam (HCMC) · USA EST · EU CET. Time zone coverage end to end.

WHY NOW

Market Moment

India has moved from talent destination to *strategic build location.*

01 · GCC CENTRES

2,117

Global Capability Centres operating in India.

NASSCOM · Zinnov GCC Landscape FY26.

02 · PROFESSIONALS

2.36M

GCC headcount across India, FY26.

Reuters / NASSCOM FY26 · nearing 2030 forecast.

03 · SECTOR REVENUE

$98.4B

Annual revenue from India offshore tech hubs.

Reuters / NASSCOM FY26.

04 · COST OF REPLACEMENT

up to 213%

Of annual salary for senior and executive roles.

Center for American Progress.

THE TALHIVE THESIS

India GCCs are no longer offshore support centres, they are strategic execution hubs for engineering, product, AI, data and cyber. Companies no longer win by opening roles in India. They win by identifying the right leadership layer, sequencing the build correctly, and hiring operators who span global expectations and local execution.

SOURCES India GCC Talent Report 2025 · Zinnov 2025–26 Strategic Review · Venator Search Partners CXO Tracker FY25 · Center for American Progress · Harvard Business Review.

01 · THE PROBLEM

Section opener

The visible vacancy is rarely the *real problem.*

Senior hiring breaks when the company has not defined the business problem behind the role. A VP Engineering mandate is not a JD. It is a decision on architecture, team design, delivery culture and the next twenty four months of execution.

THE SEVEN STEP BREAK CHAIN

01	02	03	04	05	06	07
Unclear mandate	Wrong target company map	Weak passive outreach	Poor shortlist	Slow interview loops	Candidate drop off	Restart. 6 to 12 weeks lost

SENIOR ROLES OPEN > 60 DAYS

78%

Talhive intake survey 2025

BRIEFS MISALIGNED AT KICKOFF

62%

Talhive mandate audit

TOP CANDIDATES JUGGLING 3+ OFFERS

84%

Senior IC and lead, 2025

REPLACEMENT WITHIN 12 MONTHS

31%

Industry average

CHRO HOURS / WEEK ON HIRING OPS

45%

When the funnel breaks

SOURCES SHRM 2024 Talent Acquisition Report · LinkedIn Talent Solutions 2024 · Talhive senior search benchmarks across 1,200+ mandates 2016 to 2025.

02 · THE SOLUTION

Driver framework

Talhive builds the search *before entering the market.*

01

MANDATE ARCHITECTURE

Pressure tested *before outreach.*

We pressure test the role, success outcomes, reporting context, compensation, decision process and non negotiables **before outreach begins.** The brief is the search.

02

PASSIVE MARKET MAPPING

Where the right people *already work.*

We identify where the right people already work, why they may move, and the proposition that will earn their attention. **20K+ curated pool**, mapped against 140+ target firms per mandate.

03

EVIDENCE LED ASSESSMENT

Beyond the CV, *against twelve dimensions.*

Every shortlisted candidate is evaluated on motivation, operating style, scale fit, stakeholder maturity, execution history and retention risk. **Maximum five shortlisted profiles per mandate.**

04

CLOSE AND INTEGRATION

From offer *to month three.*

We manage candidate conviction, offer risk, references, counteroffer dynamics and the first ninety days of onboarding signals. **The hire is not complete at signature.**

Speed comes from clarity, not from skipping design.

Documented in Talhive Practice Manual v4.2

02 · THE SOLUTION

Services and method

Three engagement models. One *search standard.*

SEARCH

Executive *Search.*

Retained search for CXO, VP, Director, Head of, senior IC and specialist roles where the market is narrow and the consequence of error is high.

RETAINED · SINGLE ROLE FOCUS

BUILD

India GCC *Build.*

Leadership first hiring programs for global companies building or scaling India capability across engineering, product, data, AI, cloud, cybersecurity and operations.

SCOPED PER PHASE

GROW

Embedded *Hiring / RPO.*

Dedicated hiring capacity for companies running multiple priority roles. Structured through monthly retainers, SLAs, reporting cadence and hiring governance.

MONTHLY RETAINER

EIGHT STAGE METHOD · CLIENT SIGN OFF AT EVERY GATE

01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08
GATE	GATE	GATE	GATE		GATE		GATE
Agreement	Stakeholder	Manifesto	Profile	Discovery	Synopsis	Interview	Close

PROCESS Gates require client sign off before progressing to the next stage. Documented in Talhive Practice Manual v4.2.

02 · THE SOLUTION

Competitive positioning

Why retained search is *different* from recruitment supply.

DIMENSION	CONTINGENT AGENCY	INTERNAL TEAM	GENERIC SEARCH FIRM	TALHIVE
Starting Point	JD intake	Internal interpretation	Search brief	Mandate architecture
Talent Access	Active market	Known networks	Warm senior networks	Passive first market map
Evaluation	CV + interview	Panel interviews	Consultant notes	Evidence led synopsis
Accountability	Success fee only	Internal ownership	Placement focused	Placement + retention discipline
Best Use Case	Volume roles	Ongoing hiring	Executive replacement	India leadership, GCC, senior tech and product

SOURCE Industry benchmarks: SHRM 2024 · LinkedIn TS 2024. Talhive figures calculated from 2016 to 2025 mandate data across 1,200+ placements.

03 · THE PROOF

Six years against benchmarks

Proof is not volume. Proof is *repeatable outcomes.*

PLACEMENTS

1,200+

Senior closes **2016 to 2025**.
Talhive operating data.

GLOBAL CLIENTS

270+

Across **India, USA, EU and SEA**.
Founders, CHROs, GCC leaders.

CURATED NETWORK

20K+

Senior professionals, **pre vetted**.
Talhive proprietary pool.

12 MONTH RETENTION

93%

Internally verified across retained placements.
Talhive operating data.

TRUSTED BY 270+ CLIENTS

NBA	DNEG	Atlan	Loopio	Writesonic	Arya.ai	ketteQ	Brabender
Khatabook	Dream11	Linde	Sundial	Razorpay	Starform	Cred	+254 more

SOURCES Talhive operating data 2016 to 2025 · SHRM 2024 · LinkedIn Talent Solutions 2024 · ChurnZero B2B NPS benchmark.

03 · THE PROOF

Case study. Building NBA's India *engineering capability.*

Six senior closes in eleven weeks. 100% offer acceptance. Six of six retained at month eighteen.

SITUATION

NBA needed senior engineering talent in India for a strategic digital products build. Previous search efforts had not produced the right calibration.

MANDATE

Identify senior engineering talent with **global product maturity, strong execution history and India market fit.** Six closes across leadership and senior IC.

TALHIVE ACTION

Rebuilt the brief, mapped target companies, approached passive talent, assessed candidates through structured evidence and managed offer closure end to end.

OUTCOME

Six senior roles closed in eleven weeks. 100% offer acceptance. All six retained at month eighteen.

BEFORE → AFTER · WITHIN 90 DAYS

TIME TO SHORTLIST 8 wks → 11 days	OFFER ACCEPT RATE 55% → 100%
RETENTION @ 18 MO — → 6 of 6	FOUNDER HOURS / WK 12 hrs → 2 hrs

> *Talhive has been an outstanding partner for NBA in helping us find top engineering talent in India.*

Gwen Lockington
Head of HR, Asia & India
NBA

VERIFIED Numbers verified by NBA HR. Full dossier available on request under NDA.

03 · THE PROOF

ROI math

The economics of senior hiring are *asymmetric.*

A failed senior hire is not just a recruitment cost. It creates lost execution time, leadership distraction, team instability, delayed product milestones and customer impact.

IF THE HIRE FAILS

Replacement cost · senior level

up to 213%

Of annual salary for senior and executive roles, including direct, indirect and opportunity costs. Source: Center for American Progress.

–

TALHIVE FEE

Retained · percent of base

20–30%

Engagement plus success structure. Paid in two stages. 90 day replacement guarantee included on every retained close.

=

NET ASYMMETRY

Risk reduced versus fee

~7×

Scenario, not a sourced fact: hedging a 213% replacement cost with a 30% retained fee. Real benefit compounds when the right hire is made on first attempt.

The arithmetic stops working only when the role isn't strategic. At senior level, it almost never is.

SOURCES SHRM (6×) · Harvard Business Review (9× for senior roles) · Center for American Progress (213% of salary all roles).

04 · NEXT STEPS

Engagement model

We build the search *before* we enter the market.

Talhive engagements begin with mandate architecture, not CV movement. We align the business need, target market, compensation reality, decision process, candidate proposition and close strategy before outreach starts.

Day 0–7

Calibrate.

- Mandate architecture and stakeholder alignment
- Success outcomes, comp reality and decision process
- Target company universe and candidate thesis

Day 7–21

Map & engage.

- Passive market mapping across relevant talent pools
- Role narrative for senior candidates, not generic outreach
- Early compensation, motivation and counteroffer checks

Day 21–45

Shortlist & decide.

- Evidence led shortlist with written synopses
- Structured interviews and feedback cadence
- Fit, risk, compensation and close probability aligned

Day 45–90

Close & protect.

- Offer strategy, references and counteroffer management
- Notice period tracking and joining confidence
- Post placement support and replacement protection as agreed

ENGAGEMENT STRUCTURE · BUILT FOR SINGLE SEARCHES AND MULTI ROLE PROGRAMS

Retained / Exclusive

Senior delivery capacity is reserved. The mandate is owned, not supplied as profile volume.

Scope based structure

Single leadership search, multi role buildout, GCC hiring program or embedded hiring support.

Transparent before kickoff

Process, timelines, ownership, decision cadence and commercials agreed before search starts.

Multiple hiring models

Phased retainers, project programs or role based search fees depending on scope and volume.

The goal is simple: prevent the most expensive failure in senior hiring — entering the market with an unclear brief, losing weeks to weak profiles, and restarting after candidates have already formed an impression of the role.

PROCESS Commercials are finalised after mandate calibration and depend on role seniority, exclusivity, search complexity, number of hires, timeline and engagement model.

04 · NEXT STEPS

Founder led · every mandate

Founder led at the points where *judgment matters most.*



FOUNDER & CEO

Som Nautiyal

LinkedIn

Som leads Talhive's strategic direction and business design, with a focus on operating model development, commercial structuring, and international expansion. He works with founders and senior leadership teams on business strategy, execution planning, and organisational decisions that require operating discipline and market judgment.

- Business strategy, systems design, and international expansion
- Background across talent, consulting, and fintech
- Built across Talhive, Vyaparcred, and Woodbox

BUSINESS STRATEGY | OPERATING MODEL | INTERNATIONAL EXPANSION



CO FOUNDER & COO

Pratik Mokashi

LinkedIn

Pratik leads Talhive's delivery organisation, covering hiring execution, process discipline, and team buildouts. He works with clients and internal teams on mandate execution and delivery planning where consistency and responsiveness are non negotiable.

- Hiring execution, process discipline, and team buildouts
- Background across WNS, Profile Options, and WrapZyners
- Grounded in delivery operations and execution reliability

DELIVERY ORGANISATION | PROCESS DISCIPLINE | EXECUTION RELIABILITY

04 · NEXT STEPS

FAQs

Answers to the questions *before you ask them.*

01 *Why do you work on a retainer?*

Because senior hiring cannot be run like CV supply. A retained search allows us to build the mandate properly **before entering the market**: role architecture, stakeholder alignment, compensation reality, target company mapping, candidate proposition, assessment criteria and closing strategy.

The retainer funds the architecture of the search, protects senior delivery capacity, and signals to passive candidates that the mandate is serious. In contingent hiring, many agencies work the same role lightly. **In retained search, one partner owns the outcome deeply.**

02 *Why not try contingent first?*

Because the cheapest search model is often the most expensive route for a strategic hire. Contingent search is useful for roles where the talent pool is broad, active and easy to compare. **It is not designed for leadership hiring, confidential replacement, India market entry, GCC buildouts, or senior technical roles where the best candidates are not looking.**

In those mandates, the cost of delay is materially larger than the cost of search. A missing VP Engineering, Country Head, Head of Product or senior technical leader can slow product velocity, delay hiring under them, weaken investor confidence, stretch founder bandwidth, and postpone market execution.

CONTINGENT SEARCH ASKS	RETAINED SEARCH ASKS
"Who can send resumes fastest?"	*"Who is the right person, where are they, why would they move, and how do we close them?"*

03 *How fast can you show candidates?*

Speed depends on clarity. For retained mandates, the first shortlist typically follows mandate calibration, target mapping and outreach validation.

We do not rush weak profiles to create activity. Our goal is not more candidates. It is the *right few* candidates with evidence. A fast shortlist is useful only if it survives interview scrutiny.

04 *What if the hire doesn't work out?*

Every retained placement includes a **90 day replacement guarantee**. If the candidate exits or materially fails within the guarantee period, we restart the search at no additional search fee.

The guarantee exists because we are confident in the process. Our real focus is **reducing the chance of replacement in the first place.**

05 *Can you support India GCC builds?*

Yes. This is one of our strongest use cases. We recommend a **leadership first approach**: anchor the senior leader or core technical leadership layer first, then sequence the team around them. This prevents companies from hiring isolated ICs before the operating model, decision rights and technical direction are clear. Active delivery in Mumbai, Pune, Bengaluru and Ho Chi Minh City. Native coverage across EST, CET, GMT and IST.

STILL HAVE A QUESTION? search@talhive.com · We answer within one business day · 24 hours / 4 time zones.

NEXT STEP

Start with a thirty minute *mandate calibration.*

You leave with a sharper role, whether or not we work together. If the mandate is clear, fundable and suited to retained search, we share a proposal. If it needs rethinking, we will say that before you spend six weeks in the wrong market.

- 01. *No proposal until the mandate is clear, signed and survivable.*
- 02. *Retainer means search architecture, senior accountability, delivery capacity.*
- 03. *Ninety day replacement guarantee on every retained close.*

WHERE WE OPERATE

India
Mumbai · Pune · Bengaluru

Vietnam
Ho Chi Minh City

Coverage
EST · CET · GMT · IST

Founded
2016 · Global since 2021

REACH THE FOUNDERS

Two operators.
Two continents.
One playbook.

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